Natural Ecosystems (p281-285)

Organisms live surrounded by other organisms and by non-living things such as rocks, water and soil.

Interdependence

1. Describe an example of where one living thing depends on another for survival.

2. What does the term **interdependent** mean?

Ecology

1. What is ecology?

2. What is an organism's **environment**?

3. What is a **habitat**?

4. How is a habitat different from an environment?

Ecosystems

1. What is an **ecosystem**?

2. What are the three main components of ecosystems?
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Factors Influencing Organisms

Organisms in an ecosystem can be affected by two main sets of factors: the actions of living organisms and the non-living surroundings.

1. What are **abiotic factors**? Give two examples.

2. What are **biotic factors**? Give two examples.

3. Complete the table below to show some abiotic factors in an ecosystem by explaining how each factor can affect living organisms.

Abiotic factor (physical factor)	How this factor can affect living organisms
Water	
Temperature	
Fire	
Light	
Soil minerals	
Gas level	

4. Complete the table below by giving the definition and an example of each of the biotic factors in an ecosystem.

Biotic factor	Definition	Example
Competition		
Predation		
Mutualism		
Commensalism		
Parasitism		
Decomposers		